YEAR 8 SCIENCE: BUSHFIRE RESEARCH ASSIGNMENT

TASK DESCRIPTION
The following research on bushfires is to be performed **individually.**
You will be provided with class time and the information to complete this assignment.

RESEARCH

This assignment is divided into three parts:

PART 1 Australian Bush: Read the page on 'Bushfires' and answer the following questions:

a. How did Australian aborigines use fire?
b. How did the aborigines use of fire change our forests?
c. What benefits did this have for the ecosystem?
d. How did the arrival of Europeans change the pattern of fires?

PART 2 A Bushfire Disaster: Read the article 'Australian Bushfires – Case Studies'
Answer the following questions:

a. List in point form the main effects of a catastrophic (large) bushfire disaster.
b. After reading the articles on bushfire disasters, write an account of how it would feel to be present during such a disaster.
c. How can families reduce the risk of losing: i) property and ii) life?

PART 3 How can bushfires change the land?
Observe the bushland that is:

a. Unaffected (has not yet experienced a bush fire recently)
b. burnt

Make at least 10 observations (notes describing what you see) about the differences between these two areas, to show how fire affects the bush.

Things you can observe are
i) soil
ii) ground cover (humus)
iii) plant life (ground plants, trees, regrowth)
iv) animal life (insects, reptiles, birds, mammals)

After recording your observations, use the information from **parts 1,2** and **3** to write 1-2 paragraphs on the following question:

HOW DO BUSHFIRES CHANGE THE COUNTRY?